



ARM2SID Setup for MB6582

Background

With the availability of genuine MOS SID Chips becoming scarcer and scarcer, it makes sense to look for modern and readily available alternatives for most (maybe even all) of the use cases where SID chips have traditionally been used, and MIDIBox synths are no exception.

We all *love* the fact that the MIDIBox SammichSID and MB6582 Synths provide support for multiple sound chips, which gives them their rich & multi-layered soundscapes, but finding and sourcing those 40yr antiques is risky, because there are lots of fakes and duds out there, as well as expensive (e.g., rates between \$50-\$100 USD per chip).

Fortunately there are plenty of SID Clone options out there, ranging from the SwinSID and SwinSID Ultimate, to the FPGA SID, BackSID, SIDKick, X-SID, and many others, but my personal favorite is the Nobomi ARMSID, available from <https://Retrocomp.cz>

For my taste, it provides very accurate sound reproduction, it has a clean design aesthetic, which looks great, as well as a form factor that's really close to the original MOS SID, which helps it fits everywhere a SID would. It's also reasonably priced at around ~\$30 USD, and it has a well maintained firmware codebase, which is regularly updated.

To that last point regarding firmware maintenance, some music synth owners were complaining about having to keep a working Commodore 64 around in order to run a program to update their ARMSID firmware. So, the Retrocomp team responded by creating the ARMSID Shield, which makes it super easy to update firmware, manage settings and configurations and even test sound reproduction, using real SID music.

You can find plenty of info about the ARMSID and its Arduino shield on the Retrocomp.cz website.

The purpose of this guide is to help you get up and running quickly with your Arduino ARMSID Shield, so you can properly prepare your ARMSIDs and ARM2SIDs before placing them in your MIDIBox Synth

Step 1 -Getting Started...

- Buy some ARMSIDs or ARM2SIDs and the ARMSID Shield from the Retrocomp.cz shop (sold with and